

Test 2 answer key

Reading and Use of English



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 1

1 B 2 C 3 B 4 D 5 A 6 C 7 D 8 B

Part 2

9 Despite 10 up 11 there 12 every/each 13 has/needs
14 it 15 who 16 in

Part 3

17 abilities 18 astonishment 19 accuracy 20 identification
21 unexpected 22 basic 23 differences 24 highly

Part 4

25 you MUST | have/'ve left
26 NOT (supposed/meant/intended) to be | used
27 PUT us off | seeing
28 in FAVOUR of | banning
29 be ASKED | to show
30 was not/wasn't PREPARED | to share

Part 5

31 B 32 C 33 A 34 D 35 C 36 D

Part 6

37 F 38 C 39 A 40 B 41 G 42 E

Part 7

43 C 44 A 45 D 46 B 47 B 48 A 49 D 50 B 51 C 52 A

Test 2 answer key

Listening

Part 1

1 B 2 A 3 C 4 A 5 A 6 B 7 C 8 A



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 2

9 sports centre / center 10 light 11 brakes 12 (tree) root 13 wolves
14 ghost 15 (the) (thick) mud 16 distraction 17 hail 18 canal

Part 3

19 G 20 A 21 D 22 B 23 H

Part 4

24 C 25 A 26 C 27 B 28 B 29 A 30 B

Audioscript

Test Two.

This is the B2 First for Schools Listening test.

I'm going to give you the instructions for this test. I'll introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you'll hear this sound:

tone

You will hear each piece twice.

Remember, while you are listening, write your answers on the question paper. You'll have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.

There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.

[pause]

Now open your question paper and look at Part One.

[pause]

PART 1 You will hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Question 1 You hear a young man talking about a trip to a historic site.

[pause]

tone

Boy: I first saw this historic site in a magazine when I was a kid and I dreamt of going there one day. When my family did take me years later, it was really misty and wet, which I'd been warned was to be expected at that time of the year. We went on a guided tour, even though I tend to be quite critical of tours and can find them slightly boring. This guide seemed to know his stuff though. The ancient stones were really crumbling away. I guess I'd been a bit misled by all these awesome photos I'd seen that seemed to show it in a pretty good state.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 2 You hear a teenage girl telling a friend about a book she has read.

[pause]

Boy: Do you think I'd like that novel?

Girl: You mean *Rooftoppers*? I don't know. I love it

Boy: I tend to go for stories you think could actually happen.

Girl: That's what I thought. The main character's a girl called Sophie. She's very rebellious and independent, which some people around her find hard to deal with. She was abandoned as a baby, and she spends a lot of the story searching for her mother in Paris.

Boy: Did it take you long to read?

Girl: No. It starts off quite slowly, but then Sophie ends up virtually living on the rooftops of Paris, and a lot goes on there. It's hardly very realistic, but it's really cool.

tone

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 2 answer key

Question 3

You hear part of a programme about amber, a natural material used in some jewellery.

[pause]

tone

Woman: A Chinese scientist's eye was caught by the unmistakeable glow of pieces of amber when walking through a market while on holiday. The seller said it had been discovered among rocks on a beach in the local area and suggested that some amber would be perfect for a brooch for the scientist's wife. Suspecting that some of the pieces might hold something more valuable, the scientist inspected them more closely. Inside one lump was a tiny dinosaur's tail. Careful analysis revealed that it is about 99 million years old. The scientist's wife never got her brooch but she and her husband are planning to return to the area to find amber themselves.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 4

You hear a boy telling his friend about his brother's job.

[pause]

tone

Boy: My brother's a sports therapist – he helps people with sports-related injuries. He studied the subject for three years at university, and now he works with a football team.

Girl: Is it hard to find work as a sports therapist?

Boy: Well, yes, it's very competitive. But actually, he got several offers, and had to decide which one to take.

Girl: And how does he find the work?

Boy: He really appreciates getting to spend time with some quite famous people. And he says helping them get back to full strength after an injury is rewarding. But it's a tough job – they can be fairly demanding – my brother's not one to be put off by that though.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 5 *You hear two students talking about a history lecture they've been to.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: What did you think of the history lecture today? I'm glad I'd read something about it beforehand otherwise I wouldn't have got anything out of it.

Boy: I'd actually studied it for homework, but there was loads of detail about the medieval period which the speaker just read out from his notes – I couldn't take it all in – and I'd expected that to be the highlight of the whole thing.

Girl: Well, he didn't really try and bring it to life like I thought he would – he could've told us about all the castles and stuff. If I hadn't read up on it, I guess I might've felt like you – a bit lost.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6 *You hear a boy telling his friend about his volleyball final next weekend.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: How are you feeling about the volleyball next week? Your team's done brilliantly to get into the final!

Boy: Yeah and we've been playing pretty well up till now, although we were always seen as the favourites to win the championship, you know. And everyone's pretty convinced we'll be bringing home the winners' cup, so there'll be loads more fans at the game than we're used to.

Girl: So what's standing in your way?

Boy: Well, the team we're playing against are a bit of an unknown quantity. I mean, if they happen to be on top form, as they were earlier in the tournament, we may struggle.

Girl: Well, you can't do anything about that.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 2 answer key

Question 7 *You hear a girl telling a friend about a pencil museum she visited.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: You'll never believe it but we went to a pencil museum last weekend!

Boy: What? Just pencils? Sounds a bit dull to me!

Girl: Well, believe it or not, I like that kind of weird place, though it never occurred to me there'd be such crowds of people there, all taking selfies next to the exhibits.

Boy: Surely there must've been different kinds of stationery as well?

Girl: No, just pencils – ordinary ones and coloured ones, though. You'd be amazed at the number they have exhibited there – in all different shapes and sizes. I particularly liked the world's biggest colouring pencil – it's 7.9 metres long and weighs nearly 450 kilos.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 8 *You hear a teacher telling her class about a science competition their school took part in.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: Now, news about the team from our school who won the Science Competition. As you know, they designed an experiment to test what happens when a volcano erupts, using basic things they found around the home. And I'm delighted to say that the judges were full of praise for the way they presented their data. And what's interesting is that they were all impressed when the team admitted that the experiment wasn't perfect – that's something worth bearing in mind for your own work. Anyway, the science department's spending the cash prize on equipment that'll benefit everyone studying science, and several teams have already got together to plan experiments for next term's competition.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part One.

Now turn to Part Two.

PART 2

You will hear a boy called Mark giving a class presentation about a mountain biking trip he went on. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.

[pause]

tone

Last summer, I cycled over a hundred kilometres across Scotland, from the west to the east coast. I did it with my dad, and our guide, who was called Jim, and three other people who were Australians. The starting point was just outside a town called Fort William. Dad had arranged to meet the others in a carpark there. We eventually found them waiting next to a sports centre, but not before we'd hung around by a supermarket due to Dad's mistake with the directions!

Jim had the bikes ready for us. I'd never ridden a mountain bike before. They have strong frames because of the rough treatment they get. Most are quite heavy, but to make transportation easier, some can be very light. Mine certainly was – much more than I expected really. The better bikes, like the ones we had, have extra suspension, which makes them more comfortable – that helps, of course.

The main difference from normal road bikes, though, is that the tyres are very thick. Also, the pedals have special attachments, which I'd never used before – they stop your feet slipping out. And the handlebars are flat – they're designed like that to help with the steering. The brakes need to be powerful, and they were – it took me quite a while to adapt to them.

We soon entered a forest, with a narrow, winding track to ride on. One moment I'd be swerving round a big pool of water, the next moment I felt I was about to crash into a huge rock. And I did eventually come off when I hit a massive tree root – it was sticking out of the ground. But I didn't get hurt.

We didn't come across that much wildlife in the forest, though some wildcats are supposed to live there – I think they're very rare. There were loads of rabbits, and we did spot some deer. I thought they were lovely, though they're a problem, as they eat young plants and have no natural predators. Apparently wolves were once their predators, which I couldn't believe, but they can no longer be found in the area.

We stayed in a remote hostel on the first night of the trip. After dinner, Jim told us about the history of the area. According to one legend, the building we stayed in has a ghost. I don't believe in that sort of thing, but I must admit I couldn't get the idea out of my head. Jim also mentioned a lake nearby where a monster is said to live – something I felt was an entertaining story but highly unlikely.

We set off early on the second day, and soon started to climb a very steep path. The first bit was covered in leaves which were so slippery I almost gave up and carried the bike. I actually stuck at it – then we reached some thick mud and none of us could ride anymore. So, we had to push our bikes for a while.

That was the hardest part of the trip. The track was so steep. I was feeling a bit miserable, even though once we got above the trees, the view was spectacular. Then an eagle suddenly appeared overhead. It was magnificent, and watching it flying around was a welcome distraction from the hard cycling.

We eventually made it to the top of the mountain, and from there, it was mainly downhill, which was easier. That area gets lots of rain, and often there are strong winds as it's so high up, but we were lucky with the weather mostly. Halfway down, we were hit by hail – it was horrible but only lasted about ten minutes.

Test 2 answer key

For the last stage, we rode on a track which went alongside a canal. Apparently we were actually riding on what used to be an old railway line. It wasn't as exciting as being up on the mountain, but none of us minded. When we finally got to the town of Inverness, we were starving and had a big dinner to celebrate getting there. The whole trip was an amazing experience.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Two again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Two.

Now turn to Part Three.

PART 3

You will hear five extracts in which teenagers are talking about a free time activity they have given up. For questions 19 to 23, choose from the list (A to H) why each speaker gave up the activity. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use. 1

You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.

[pause]

tone

Speaker 1

I've taken dance classes since I was a little kid and it's always been a major part of my life. Having reached an advanced level though, I don't have the feeling I'm improving anymore, which is pretty frustrating. I'm not saying I'll never dance again, but I've stopped going to classes. My old teacher suggested I should apply for a place at a specialist ballet school, but I'm definitely not keen enough to do that – apart from anything, the fees would be really high. The other thing is, I've now got more time to do some of my other hobbies, like skating and drawing.

[pause]

Speaker 2

I went to orchestra practice for years, even when the buzz I used to get from playing the trumpet had worn off. I suppose I felt a sense of obligation – my parents had spent a fortune on my instrument when I begged them to let me learn. I did work hard at it for several years, though, and I learned tons about music, which got me interested in composing music. That's what I really want to concentrate on now, and I just don't feel like playing the trumpet at the same time. My parents are alright about it, though. They know that people's interests change as they get older – mine certainly have.

[pause]

Speaker 3

I did something called 'the challenge'. It was about pushing yourself to try new things every week. I learned to rock climb, sail and grow vegetables. It's not for everyone. Some kids just wouldn't like the routine of having to keep getting out there every single week. I started to resent how much was expected of us – if you wanted to miss a week, you'd have to give your reasons for not going, which was a bit of a pain. It took up a lot of my free time and when I got into my teens, I just wanted a bit more alone time just to chill out instead.

[pause]

Speaker 4

My dad introduced me to making model aeroplanes when I was six. We'd spend Saturdays going to shops to buy rare or interesting models – they'd cost an awful lot – Dad didn't seem to mind though. We'd come home, put them together and paint them. Eventually I took up a more 'mature' hobby – it's not that I wasn't interested in doing model making any more, it was more that I'd outgrown it – that's what I thought, anyway. So I formed a band with some mates, even though it was hard to fit in practice with all the homework we were being given. I doubt we'll ever become famous, we're not motivated enough for that, but it's fun.

[pause]

Test 2 answer key

Speaker 5

[pause]

Writing's a solitary activity. There are classes you can go to – they cost quite a lot though, and I don't think they're worth it. I'm not the best writer in the world, but I used to spend most of my free time thinking up plots for short stories – I even had a couple published. But my mates were going out, doing active stuff and I started to feel cut off from them. They told me writing wasn't a hobby for someone young like me to be doing, so I decided to join them more, and now my writing's kind of got pushed to one side. I might take it up again in the future, though.

[pause]

Now you'll hear Part Three again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Three.

Now turn to Part Four.

PART 4

You will hear an interview with a student called Daniella Masters, talking about a day she spent with a professional wildlife photographer called John Baker. For questions 24 to 30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part Four.

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: I'm with student Daniella Masters, who's just spent a day with professional wildlife photographer John Baker. Daniella, not many people can take great wildlife photos, can they?

Daniella: That's right. I'd never been very successful! Then amazingly, I won a competition to spend a day with John, and learn more about how it's done! John's so experienced, and he feels we've lost the necessary photography skills because we spend too much time in front of screens and not enough in the natural world. He also thinks people don't have enough patience – they don't plan what they're going to shoot before heading out with their cameras and then they just give up when their photos don't live up to expectations. And he was right in my case!

Interviewer: And you and John had several wild animals you wanted to photograph, among them an otter ...?

Daniella: Yes – if you've never seen an otter, they're quite big, very cute, furry creatures that spend most of their lives in water. They're hard to find, but John was confident we'd be successful. And sure enough, walking by a river, we suddenly noticed one swimming along, and I got out my camera. It was frustrating because at that exact moment, a dog jumped into the water to chase a stick its owner had thrown in – and the otter disappeared. But I think you just have to accept that wildlife will sometimes be scared off – and anyway, I wouldn't have caught what turned out to be a stunning motion shot of the dog if it hadn't come along just then!

Interviewer: So did John give you tips about finding wildlife to photograph?

Daniella: Well, I hadn't realised that many great photos are actually set up artificially. For example, we wanted to film some water birds, but they were incredibly fast-moving. John said the only sure way was to specially prepare a branch, and leave some food for them. He'd also built a shelter for us to hide in and wait. It wasn't long before I'd captured the birds on film.

Interviewer: And what about getting the best from your camera?

Daniella: Well, I'm afraid I'm one of those people who have all the gadgets, but little knowledge, so John's advice was invaluable. He showed me features on my camera I didn't even know existed. I'd attempted to play around with things like focus and filters, but then John showed me how to adjust the shutter speed, and let me compare the differences in my shots – amazing!

Interviewer: So how did your pictures improve?

Daniella: Well, we stopped to review the shots we'd taken. I'd got one of a beautiful white swan against the dark water. I was pretty pleased with it, but then John pointed out I'd overexposed the picture – let too much light in – so the swan was completely white, and I hadn't captured the details of its feathers. He said the next photo I took was a bit closer to what he wanted, although I was secretly just as pleased with my first one! Anyway, I also learnt to take more care about the background, which I sometimes overlook.

Test 2 answer key

Interviewer: And then you drove to the coast to photograph some seals?

Daniella: That's right. We walked for ages across the sand looking for them – I was beginning to give up hope. But then we spotted a huge group! John suggested we'd get better pictures if we got nearer. We walked slowly, keeping low down so as not to disturb them. John advised me to use his long lens and get down to the seals' eye level to capture how they looked in the wild – that produced the desired results. Inevitably, though, once we got even closer, they started to get nervous and headed back into the sea, so we left.

Interviewer: So how did you feel at the end of the day?

Daniella: Oh tired! It'd been really full-on, and there'd been loads of information to take in. The overriding feeling, though, was regret for how much I must've missed on previous trips to the countryside, by just not paying close enough attention to what was there. Anyway, I could see much more clearly where improvements could be made with my photography, so I can only hope I'll become as good as John one day!

Interviewer: Daniella, thanks.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Four again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Four.

There will now be a pause of five minutes for you to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet. Be sure to follow the numbering of all the questions. I'll remind you when there's one minute left, so that you're sure to finish in time.

[pause – four minutes]

You have one more minute left.

[pause – one minute]

That's the end of the test. Please stop now. Your supervisor will now collect all the question papers and answer sheets.